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NIKHAT ZAREEN *(Boxing)*

'World Champion' Nikhat Zareen is eager to perform at her first CWG. Zareen, who had been unable to find a place in the Indian CWG squad before this as she competed in the same weight category as boxing legend M.C. Mary Kom, will finally get her chance this year. She qualified for the event days after winning the World Championship in 52kg. This will be the first time that the 26-year-old will be competing in the 50kg category. She hopes to use her height to her advantage.

MIRABAI CHANU *(Weightlifting)*

After claiming India's first medal at the Tokyo Olympics, Mirabai Chanu is expected to rake in more medal glory in Birmingham. Gold in 49kg is Chanu's to lose, as her nearest rival, Nigeria's Stella Kingsley, has recorded a best effort of 168kg. Chanu's personal best is 205kg. The 27-year-old won gold in 48kg at the 2018 Gold Coast CWG and will lead a 15-member strong Indian contingent in weightlifting. She is hoping to use the CWG platform to break her world record of 119kg in 'clean & jerk' and push past 90kg in 'snatch'—88kg is her best so far.

HOCKEY

There has been a spike in interest in Indian hockey since the Tokyo Olympics. While the men's team won the bronze to bring home India's first medal in hockey in over four decades, the women's team's scintillating run to the bronze medal playoff was the feel-good story of the Olympics. Indian men have finished runners-up twice, behind Australia, their rivals who have swept gold medals in all the six editions. Indian women won gold at the 2002 Commonwealth Games and finished fourth in the previous edition.



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SAURAV GHOSAL AND DIPIKA PALLIKAL *(Squash)*

Having won a silver at the 2018 CWG, Saurav Ghosal and Dipika Pallikal will be keen to go one step further. Since squash is not an Olympic sport, CWG is the biggest multi-sport event in the game. The eight-member contingent will rest their medal hopes in the trio of Ghosal (35), Joshna Chinappa (35) and Pallikal (30). Within six months of giving birth to twins, Pallikal won two golds—mixed doubles with Ghosal and women's doubles with Chinappa—at the World Doubles Championship in April.

- By Deepti Patwardhan



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INDIA PICTURE